

2020. This growth in the Indian electronics market is sure to create more job avenues for the Indian engineering community.

The Indian electronics industry was pegged at about \$65 billion in 2010. The global electronics market is estimated to reach \$1800 billion. The mobile revolution, expanding middle class, growing emphasis on quality healthcare, increasing government spend on aerospace and defence, and enhancing significance of energy efficiency are key trends influencing the growth in the Indian electronics market.

Tablet PC users to increase at 107 per cent annually

According to a Frost & Sullivan report, the overall tablet PC user base in India is likely to grow 107 per cent annually to reach 23.38 million by 2017.



"Though the tablet ecosystem is at a nascent stage, the proliferation of tablets is expected to increase significantly with the launch of faster data technologies and growing awareness among customers. The success of tablets in India would depend on affordability, applications with vernacular support and quality data connectivity," observes Abhishek Chauhan, senior consultant, ICT Practice, Frost & Sullivan, South Asia and Middle East.

The increasing adoption of 3G services and the impending launch of 4G LTE services in India will positively affect data usage in the country. Ensuring the availability of seamless Internet connectivity at nominal prices will drive the tablet PC sales.

NI co-founders honoured

The Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars has honoured National Instruments (NI) co-founders Dr James Truchard and Jeff Kodosky with the *Woodrow Wilson Award for Corporate Citizenship*. The award recognises those executives who in their business practices and personal actions show a deep concern for the common good beyond the bottom line.

In another good news for the company, Frost & Sullivan has honoured National Instruments India with *2011 Technology Innovation of the Year Award* in test and measurement category for its PXI product line.

Tejas wins TCOE award of excellence

Tejas Networks has won government of India's *TCOE Award of Excellence in Telecom Products*. Tejas was adjudged best in the category of 'Indian companies with excellent telecom product profile.' The award nominees were judged based on parameters like research and innovation, IP/patents generated and market acceptance for the products under consideration.

India among lowest paying employers in IT space

A study titled *Worldwide IT Salary 2011* reveals that the mid- to senior-level staff in Indian IT companies gets an average salary of \$36,120 per annum, which is less than one-fourth of the IT pay package at globally top-paying Swiss companies.

The IT sector salaries in Switzerland are highest in the world, at an average of \$167,890 per annum. The study was conducted by global recruitment service provider MyHiringClub.com. It revealed a list of ten worst IT paymasters in the world in which India stood seventh. The report compared the total annual cash compensation and total remuneration information for IT staff in more than 6000 companies across 41 different countries and found that employers in western Europe are the best paymasters.

Videocon to invest Rs 1 billion in R&D and expansion

Videocon plans to invest Rs 1 billion in research and development in order to strengthen its position. It will also expand its manufacturing capacities. The company invests Rs 500 to 600 million every year in research and development. For the next year, the company has plans to invest 10 per cent more. It will also bring up an entire new range in most of its product categories.

Anirudh Dhoot, director, Videocon Industries, said, "We will make another Rs 500 million investment for the new lines and upgrading the technology."

As of now, the firm has seven plants in Gujarat, Uttarakhand, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh and West Bengal.

LG to invest Rs 18 billion in India

LG Electronics is increasing its India investment in 2012 by 20 per cent to around Rs 18 billion. The firm will utilise the investment for enhancing its manufacturing capacities and marketing activities. The company is also looking at a 20 per cent increase in India sales for 2012. It will continue to bring more innovative products and increase its focus on premium range.

Soon Kwon, chief executive officer, LG Electronics India, said, "Our investment will increase as per business. We are expecting to make another 20 per cent business increase in 2012. Investment-wise too, we will be making 20 per cent more."

In 2011, LG invested Rs 15 billion in India. Of this, Rs 8 billion was used to upgrade manufacturing facilities, while the remaining Rs 7 billion was used in various marketing exercises.

BSNL introduces online education services

State-run telecom operator Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL) has